

Nickzad Bayati

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Education

M.S. Artificial Intelligence - San Jose State University, San Jose, CA | Aug 2025 - May 2027

GPA: 3.85/4.0 · Coursework: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Intelligent Autonomous Systems, Natural Language Processing

B.S. Computer Science - California Polytechnic State University (Cal Poly SLO), San Luis Obispo, CA | Sep 2019 - Jun 2023

GPA: 3.55/4.0

Skills

- **Languages:** Python, SQL, Java, JavaScript, C, C#
- **ML / DL:** PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas; CNNs & transformers; reinforcement learning (Stable-Baselines3)
- **LLM / GenAI:** RAG (ChromaDB, SentenceTransformers), prompt engineering, OpenAI-compatible APIs, Gradio & Streamlit demos, vision-language models
- **Safety / Eval:** LLM guardrails, model evaluation and reliability metrics, explainable AI
- **Software / Systems:** Git, REST APIs, Cloudflare Workers, React/Express (familiar), CUDA (familiar)

Projects

Hallucinated Visual Belief Persistence in Sequential AV Perception | [GitHub](#) | Sep 2026 - Present

- Evaluated whether vision-language models revise incorrect visual interpretations over sequential driving frames or allow early errors to persist.
- Compared stateful vs. stateless inference with Qwen2.5-VL and LLaVA-OneVision using metrics for hallucination persistence, correction latency, and safety-action accuracy.

Customer Research RAG | [GitHub](#) | Jun 2026

- Built a Streamlit app for grounded Q&A over customer interview transcripts using ChromaDB + SentenceTransformers retrieval and an OpenAI-compatible LLM.
- Delivered citation-backed answers, retrieval-only quote search, and theme synthesis so insights stay tied to source evidence.

Deepfake Image Classification | [GitHub](#) | Apr 2026 - May 2026

- Built a deepfake detection pipeline with convolutional and transformer models (ResNet-18, Dual MaxViT, distilled MobileNetV3).
- Shipped a Gradio app for interactive, real-time inference demos.

Reddit Focus (LLM feed ranking) | [GitHub](#) | Mar 2026

NVIDIA Agents for Impact Hackathon (SJSU)

- Firefox extension that classifies Reddit posts in real time (highlight / hide / neutral) via a Cloudflare Worker backed by NVIDIA Nemotron, with response caching keyed on post and user-interest profile.

LLM-Powered Codebase Security Audit CLI (Snitch-Stitch) | [GitHub](#) | Jan 2026

Best Enterprise Application - Prompt Driven Development Hackathon (500 Global)

- Collaborated on a 4-person team to build a Python CLI that audits repositories for security issues, ranks findings by severity, and proposes LLM-assisted remediation.
- Designed prompt-driven review workflows that turn static findings into actionable, prioritized guidance for engineering teams.

Explainable AI for Trajectory Classification | [GitHub](#) | Oct 2025 - Dec 2025

- Explored an explainable AI framework for trajectory classification based on segment perturbations.
- Extended the approach with a new perturbation method, temporal information, and surrogate hyperparameter tuning to improve explanation metrics.

LLM Guardrails Using ML Models | [GitHub](#) | Sep 2025 - Dec 2025

- Collaborated on a 4-person team building LLM safety guardrails, owning the toxicity guardrail end to end.
- Implemented multi-label toxicity classification in Python with scikit-learn classifier chains, comparing logistic regression, random forest, and XGBoost base models.

Experience

Product Developer Engineering Intern - Solidigm, Rancho Cordova, CA | Jun 2022 - Dec 2022

- Maintained an internal web application supporting Solidigm's SSD firmware release process.
- Owned JIRA issues end to end and delivered 10+ critical updates in Python and JavaScript.

Software Developer Intern - Intel Corporation, Folsom, CA | Jun 2018 - Aug 2018

- Maintained and enhanced a web application with C# and ASP.NET (MVC) on an Agile Scrum team.